

11th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education

Survey response 1

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GENERAL INFORMATION

Country name:
The Republic of Lithuania
Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:
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I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education[1]

Is your country a State Party to the Convention?
No
Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?
No, not considering ratification.
- Please explain why:
The majority of the statements in the UNESCO Convention are not relevant anymore and do not meet more advanced legal regulation, currently in force in Lithuania, compared to that, which is established in the Convention, adopted in 1960. Both the EU and the Council of Europe, a member of which Lithuania is, raise higher requirements/standards, related to the implementation of the human rights and non-discrimination in education. Both the Lithuanian legal base and the existing international obligations currently ensure an adequate implementation of these rights and the principle of non-discrimination in education.
Is the Convention directly applicable in your country 's domestic law ?
No

Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education [1]? [1] Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

Yes

Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked ?

Yes

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with the respect to the right to education.

Educational governance bodies are:

1. ☒ The Seimas (Parliament);
2. ☒ The Government, Ministry of Education, Science and Sports, other ministries, Government agencies;
3. ☒ Institutions authorized by the Minister of Education, Science and Sports;
4. ☒ Municipal institutions;
5. ☒ Owner of non-state schools (participants' assembly);
6. ☒ Head of educational institutions.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4). 1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

Yes

- If yes, please provide reference:

Article 41 of the Constitution establishes that education is compulsory for persons under the age of 16, education at state and municipal schools of general education, vocational schools, and schools of further education is free of charge. Higher education is accessible to everyone according to individual abilities. Well performing students shall be guaranteed education at state higher education institutions free of charge. The Law on Education of the Republic of Lithuania establishes the principles upon which the educational system is based, one of them is equal opportunities – the educational system is socially fair, it ensures the implementation of person's rights, it guarantees the access to education for all, the attainment of a general education level and a primary qualification, and creates conditions to develop the acquired qualification or gain a new one. This law also establishes the right and duty of all residents to study, indicating that each citizen and foreigners, who has the right of permanent or temporary residence in the Republic of Lithuania, has the right to study, attain an education level and a qualification. The State takes measures that in Lithuania each child studies according to pre-primary, primary, basic and secondary education curricula. The State guarantees each citizen of the Republic of Lithuania and each foreigners, who has the right of permanent or temporary residence in the Republic of Lithuania, pre-primary, primary, basic and secondary education; as well as access to higher education study programmes or vocational training programmes that result in the acquisition of the first qualification. The Law on Vocational Education also establishes the principle of equal opportunities – the vocational education system is socially fair, it ensures equality among persons, regardless of their gender, race, nationality, language, origin, social status, faith, beliefs or attitudes; it guarantees the first qualification for each person, also creating conditions to develop the qualifications already attained or acquire a new one. The Law on Higher Education and Research establishes the principles of equal opportunities and academic ethics in the Lithuanian higher education and research system.

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Legal texts (Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.) prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education]

Yes

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education]

Yes

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1], and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply): For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b [2]. [1] See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). [2] Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”. [Combating discrimination in terms of curriculum]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In primary education]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In secondary education]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In technical and vocational education and training]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In higher education]

Yes

Legal texts[1] prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: [1] Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc. [In adult education and alternative learning]

Yes

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

Article 5 of the Law on Education establishes the principles of the education system.

The principles of the education system are as follows:

Equality of opportunity - the education system is socially just, ensuring the realization of individual rights, providing access to education for everyone, acquiring general education and initial qualifications, and creating conditions for improving existing qualifications or acquiring new ones,

Contextuality - the education system is closely linked to the economic, social, and cultural context of the country's development, renewing itself along with it and meeting the constantly changing needs of society,

Efficiency - the education system aims for quality results, using available resources wisely and efficiently, constantly evaluating, analyzing, and planning its activities based on effective management - making appropriate and timely decisions,

Continuity - the education system is flexible, open, based on the interaction of various forms and institutions; it creates conditions for lifelong learning for everyone,

Inclusivity - the education system provides opportunities for everyone to develop, enhance their abilities and skills, receive necessary assistance, experience success in learning, social, cultural, and/or other activities, and not be discriminated against due to the diversity of learning needs and/or the need for educational assistance.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:
Any discrimination - direct and indirect discrimination, harassment, instruction to discriminate on the grounds of sex, race, nationality, citizenship, language, origin, social status, belief, convictions or views, age, sexual orientation, disability, ethnic origin, or religion is prohibited. Educational institutions, other education providers, as well as research and study institutions must ensure equal conditions for individuals regardless of gender, race, nationality, citizenship, language, origin, social status, belief, convictions or views, age, sexual orientation, disability, ethnic origin, or religion when admitting individuals to educational institutions, other education providers, and research and study institutions, teaching and educating according to the formal and non-formal education programs they implement, granting scholarships or providing loans, developing, approving educational programs. Educational institutions, other education providers, as well as research and study institutions, according to their competence, must ensure that educational programs, textbooks, and teaching materials do not contain discrimination or promotion of discrimination based on gender, race, nationality, citizenship, language, origin, social status, belief, convictions or views, age, sexual orientation, disability, ethnic origin, or religion. Educational institutions, other education providers, as well as research and study institutions must ensure that there is no harassment, sexual harassment, and no instructions to discriminate based on gender, race, nationality, citizenship, language, origin, social status, belief, convictions or views, age, sexual orientation, disability, ethnic origin, or religion in these institutions.
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In primary education]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In secondary education]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In technical and vocational education and training]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In higher education]
Yes
Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education: [In adult education and alternative learning]
Yes
- Please provide details:
The Law on Education establishes that education for citizens of the Republic of Lithuania living in the Republic of Lithuania and foreigners with the right to live permanently or temporarily in the Republic of Lithuania is mandatory and state-guaranteed education up to the age of 16 according to pre-school, primary and basic education programs.
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)]
No
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In primary education]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In secondary education]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In technical and vocational education and training]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In higher education]
Yes
Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum: [In adult education and alternative learning]
Yes
- Please provide details:

Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Legislation provides for inclusive education for all]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Teachers are trained on inclusive education and to value diversity]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided for]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Multilingual and intercultural education is supported]

Yes

1.2. Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked): General measures: [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Article 5 of the Law on Education establishes the principles of the education system.

The principles of the education system are as follows:

Equality of opportunity - the education system is socially just, ensuring the realization of individual rights, providing access to education for everyone, acquiring general education and initial qualifications, and creating conditions for improving existing qualifications or acquiring new ones,

Inclusivity - the education system provides opportunities for everyone to develop, enhance their abilities and skills, receive necessary assistance, experience success in learning, social, cultural, and/or other activities, and not be discriminated against due to the diversity of learning needs and/or the need for educational assistance.

If the parents (guardians, caregivers) of a student with special educational needs wish, conditions are provided for the student to be educated closer to their place of residence in a preschool education institution, mainstream school, vocational training institution, or any state, municipal (regional) school designated for students with special educational needs. The school for the child is recommended by the pedagogical-psychological service.

The vocational training institution, higher education institution establishes the procedure for admission to these schools for individuals with special educational needs.

The municipality, in whose territory they reside, is responsible for the accessibility of education for students with special educational needs. Education accessibility is ensured by adapting the school environment, providing psychological, special pedagogical, special and social pedagogical assistance, supplying technical aids for education in the school, and special teaching aids, among other methods established by law.

Social inclusion for economically disadvantaged families, refugees, children not attending school, unemployed individuals, individuals returning from correctional facilities, as well as individuals undergoing treatment for alcoholism and drug addiction, and those who do not fit into society is ensured by providing them with social services and educational assistance. Targeted social and educational programs are implemented by the Government and municipalities directly or through schools. These programs can also be developed and implemented by non-governmental organizations and other legal and natural persons. State and municipal institutions, based on data from population registers and other state and informational registries, determine the number of children not attending school and their educational needs, and together with schools, implement targeted programs to involve these children in educational activities.

In Lithuania, there are four national consultation centres: the Lithuanian Centre for Inclusive Education, the Lithuanian Centre for Education of the Blind and Visually Impaired, the Lithuanian Centre for Education of the Deaf and Hard of Hearing, and the "Diemedžio" Education Centre. These centres invite teachers, school and kindergarten leaders, education support specialists, and teacher assistants to participate in a free of charge remote consultations, thematic seminars, and training sessions on the issues of inclusive education.

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Legislation provides for gender equality in education]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing positive or affirmative action measures]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Providing financial incentives and fellowships]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)]

Yes

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

In order to assist education sector employees in promoting gender equality and non-discrimination in the education and training process, methodological recommendations have been prepared. These methodological recommendations review scientific literature and recent research, present the historical and political context of gender equality, which will facilitate a better understanding of the importance and impact of gender equality on the well-being of education sector employees, their students' well-being, and society as a whole. Practical recommendations and a self-reflection methodology are also provided as tools to help education sector employees observe and evaluate how effectively they are promoting gender equality in the teaching and education process.

The document provides recommendations on what to do and what not to do for education sector employees in order to promote gender equality and non-discrimination in the teaching and education process. It also includes a methodology for self-reflection for education sector employees. This methodology allows education sector employees themselves to observe and evaluate gender dynamics in the classroom from the perspective of gender equality. Considering this, adjustments can be made to the education process to equally include and encourage both girls and boys.

What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) [1]: Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married. [1] Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

Yes

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

Article 3.14 of the Civil Code of the Republic of Lithuania "Marriage Age" states that marriage is permitted to persons who are eighteen years of age on the date of the marriage.

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]

Yes

National minorities: For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. For 'others', please see: UNESCO report 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023. [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Every citizen of the Republic of Lithuania and a foreigner who has the right to reside permanently or temporarily in the Republic of Lithuania is guaranteed education in the state language and learning of the state language. The Law of Education establishes that in areas where a foreigner traditionally resides, if the community requests, the municipality provides education in the language of the national minority.

General education and non-formal education schools provide conditions for pupils belonging to national minorities to nurture their national, ethnic, and linguistic identity, to learn their native language, history, and culture. In general education and non-formal education schools, where, in accordance with the wishes of parents (guardians, caregivers) and pupils, education in the language of a national minority or education in the language of a national minority is legalized in the regulations, the educational process may be conducted, or some subjects may be taught in the language of a national minority. In these schools, the Lithuanian language subject is an integral part of the educational program, and no less time is allocated for its teaching than for teaching the native language. In such schools in pre-school and pre-primary education programs, no less than 5 hours per week are allocated for education in the Lithuanian language.

Primary, basic, and secondary education programs are implemented through bilingual education: in the language of a national minority and in the Lithuanian language. Lithuanian language is taught integrally in the primary education program, and in the basic and secondary education program - during those lessons when topics from Lithuanian history and geography, world cognition, and the basics of citizenship are covered;

At the request of parents (guardians, caregivers), other subjects of the primary, basic, and secondary education programs are taught in the Lithuanian language.

A person belonging to a national minority can learn their native language in a school conducting non-formal education programs or with another education provider.

Conditions are created for the children of a person who has the right to reside permanently or temporarily in the Republic of Lithuania to learn the state language, in the state language, and, if possible, to learn their native language.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Indigenous people: [Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities]

No

Indigenous people: [The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people]

No

Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained on intercultural education]

No

Indigenous people: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
No
Indigenous people: [Multilingual and intercultural education are supported]
No
Indigenous people: [Native language instruction is ensured]
No
Indigenous people: [Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people]
No
Indigenous people: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
No
Indigenous people: [Other]
N.A.
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Legislation provides for their right to education]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [All administrative barriers to access education are removed]
Yes
People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers are provided for]
Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Auxiliary assistance is provided]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multiple and flexible learning pathways are provided]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Accelerated learning programmes are provided]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Language classes to newcomers are provided for]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged]

Yes

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations[1]. [1] 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2). [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:
Encouraging the successful integration of migrant children arriving in Lithuania into mainstream education schools is a relevant part of the country's education policy. In this area, legislative acts and recommendations have been adopted at the national level defining measures to help integrate migrant students. Individuals arriving from abroad are admitted to study according to the general procedure either in a class where their peers study or in a preparatory class (group). If the individual's achievements are higher or lower than those specified in the educational program, the person has the right to study in a correspondingly higher or lower class. According to this procedure, the school creates an individual education plan for the person arriving from abroad and provides educational/learning assistance. Students who do not speak Lithuanian learn Lithuanian language for one year in a preparatory class or a preparatory mobile group before starting their sequential education in a mainstream school. Municipalities can make their own decisions regarding the integration of migrants in mainstream education schools by preparing legislation regulating the process of integrating migrant students. Efforts to improve the integration of migrant students in Lithuania are being made: through research, identifying the educational service needs of migrants, the needs of schools to promote the integration of returning or arriving children, and identifying integration measures that have proven effective in schools. A network of schools accepting and prepared to accept migrants has been established and continuously expanded, the development of non-traditional – exclusively remote education for migrants is being pursued, and the International Baccalaureate program, which makes it easier to integrate into the higher education system of foreign countries upon completion, is becoming more popular.
- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.
People with disabilities: [Legislation provides for their right to education]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Financial incentives and fellowships are provided]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Auxiliary assistance is provided]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted]
Yes
People with disabilities: [Other]

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken: A person with disabilities has the right to education, including lifelong learning, on an equal basis with others. Education for a person with disabilities is guaranteed by state funds in state and municipal preschool education institutions, schools according to formal and non-formal education programs, as well as the opportunity to study under vocational training programs in accordance with the procedure established by the Republic of Lithuania Law on Vocational Training. Health care services for a person with disabilities are ensured in educational institutions if they are necessary due to the disability. These services in educational institutions are provided in accordance with the procedure established by the Minister of Health, coordinated with the Minister of Education, Science, and Sport. The provision of premises necessary for providing health care services in educational institutions is the responsibility of the institution implementing the rights and obligations of the owner of the educational or training institution (participants' assembly). The organization of education and its accessibility for a person with disabilities is the responsibility of the Ministry of Education, Science, and Sport of the Republic of Lithuania, the education provider, the institution implementing the rights and obligations of the owner of the educational institution (participants' assembly), owners of non-state schools, and educational institutions. The Ministry of Education, Science, and Sport allocates funds for the development of inclusive education not only in general education schools but also in vocational training institutions. By 2027, a total of 114 million euros is earmarked from the European Union's investment program to ensure inclusive education in both general education and vocational training institutions. These funds will be allocated to attract specialists, enhance the competencies of working professionals, and acquire the necessary learning resources.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.
Students from poor households: [Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided] Yes
Students from poor households: [Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education] Yes
Students from poor households: [Positive or affirmative action measures are provided] Yes
Students from poor households: [Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation] Yes
Students from poor households: [Curricula are rid of all stereotypes and bias] Yes
Students from poor households: [Other]
- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken: A student who studies according to primary, basic, and secondary education programs, free of charge, uses textbooks and electronic books listed in the list approved by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sport, as well as interactive virtual learning tools. Students have the right to free lunches, meals in summer holiday camps organized by schools, and support for purchasing student supplies if the average income per capita or per household member (hereinafter referred to as the average income per capita) is less than 1.5 times the size of state-supported income per month. Municipalities, in whose territory there are educational and childcare institutions, compensate all travel expenses according to their established procedure: for students attending general education programs in villages and small towns in grades 9–12 (grades 1–4 of gymnasiums), vocational training institutions, and non-formal education institutions, who travel to school or institution up to 40 km on school or institution days.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free]

No

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable]

Yes

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis]

Yes

2.1 Early childhood care and education For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation[1] and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education[2]. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked): [1] Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. [2] Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE” [ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.]

Yes

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Pre-school education takes place in the family, and upon the request of parents (guardians), according to the pre-school education program. Mandatory free education according to the pre-school (prior to pre-primary) education program is provided for children experiencing social risk, in accordance with the procedure established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports and the Minister of Social Security and Labour. Mandatory education according to the pre-school education program may be provided for other children according to criteria and procedures established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports and the Minister of Social Security and Labour.

Preschool education is provided to a child from birth until the start of preschool education. Education according to the preschool education program is universal from the age of 4. From September 1, 2024, preschool education becomes universal from the age of 3, and from September 1, 2025, it becomes universal from the age of 2.

Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is compulsory.]
Yes
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not compulsory.]
No
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is free of charge for all.]
Yes
Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available? [Pre-primary education is not free.]
Yes
- Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:
Compulsory pre-primary education begins when a child reaches the age of 6 in that calendar year. Pre-primary education can be provided earlier by the decision of the parents (guardians), but not earlier than the child reaches the age of 5.
- Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:
In state and municipal schools, education according to pre-primary, primary, basic, secondary education programs, and vocational training programs aimed at acquiring the first qualification is free of charge. The minimum duration of the pre-primary program is 640 hours per year.
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.
Law on Education of the Republic of Lithuania, Article 2, point 23; Article 8, Article 67, paragraph 2, 4 (https://www.e-tar.lt/portal/en/legalAct/TAR.9A3AD08EA5D0/nOpuXWoCGx) The purpose of pre-primary education is to help the child prepare for successful learning according to the primary education program. Pre-primary education is carried out according to the general pre-primary education program approved by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports for one academic year. Pre-primary education is provided by pre-primary, general education schools, freelance teachers, or other education providers, following the procedure established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports. Pre-primary education begins to be provided to a child when, in that calendar year, they reach the age of 5 by April 30. According to the procedure established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports, taking into account the child's educational and learning needs, progress, pre-primary education can be started when the child reaches the age of 5 by September 1 of that calendar year. Pre-primary education may be provided later by the decision of the parents (guardians), but not later than when the child reaches the age of 6 in that calendar year. If pre-primary education was started for the child when they turned 5 in that calendar year, according to the procedure established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports, taking into account the child's educational and learning needs, progress, pre-primary education can last for two years. According to the pre-primary education program, coordinated educational assistance, social, and healthcare services are provided to a pre-primary-aged child and their parents (guardians) according to the procedure established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports, the Minister of Social Security and Labour, and the Minister of Health.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Limited access]
Yes
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Poor learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Lack of support to families]
No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
2.2 Primary and secondary education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.” Primary education - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:
Education is free of charge and compulsory from the age of 6 or 7 to 16 years (covering "primary" and "basic" education), as stated in the national Law on Education. Primary education lasts for 4 years.
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is compulsory]
Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not compulsory.]
No
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is free of charge.]
Yes
- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge? [Primary education is not free.]
No
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.
Article 41 of the Constitution establishes that education is compulsory for persons under the age of 16, education at state and municipal schools of general education, vocational schools, and schools of further education is free of charge. The Law on Education of the Republic of Lithuania establishes the right and duty of all residents to study, indicating that each citizen and alien, who has the right of permanent or temporary residence in the Republic of Lithuania, has the right to study, attain an education level and a qualification. The State takes measures that in Lithuania each child studies according to pre-primary, primary, basic and secondary education curricula. The State guarantees each citizen of the Republic of Lithuania and each alien, who has the right of permanent or temporary residence in the Republic of Lithuania, pre-primary, primary, basic and secondary education; as well as access to higher education study programmes or vocational training programmes that result in the acquisition of the first qualification.
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Limited access]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [High dropout rates]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in foundation literacy]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in numeracy]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Poor learning outcomes in social and emotional learning]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Other poor learning outcomes]
No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Disparity in learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]
No
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
Secondary education In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training. - Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:
Lower secondary education lasts for 6 years and is also compulsory. Children usually enter lower secondary education when they are 10 or 11 years of age.
- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:
Upper secondary education lasts for 2 years. Children usually enter upper secondary education when they are 16 or 17 years of age.
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is compulsory.]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not compulsory.]
No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is free of charge.]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Lower secondary education is not free of charge.]
No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is compulsory.]
No
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not compulsory.]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is free of charge]
Yes
- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge? [Upper secondary education is not free of charge.]
No
- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.
Article 70 "Payment for education" of the Law of education states that: -education in state and municipal schools according to pre-primary, primary, basic, secondary, vocational education curricula and vocational training programmes designed for the acquisition of the first qualification shall be free of charge; -the pay for education, teaching at non-state schools shall be set by the owner of the school (the meeting of the participants). The pay shall be paid on the basis of an agreement. -learners studying according to primary, basic, secondary education curricula shall use textbooks free of charge.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education: For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

In Lithuania, minors can start working from the age of 14, but depending on whether they fall into the children or adolescents age group, different restrictions apply to the nature of their work, working and rest time, as well as the formation of employment contracts. Even with a 14-year-old, work must be formalized through an employment contract, in which the parties agree on essential terms such as job functions, pay, workplace, work time norms, and work schedule. Only then are work guarantees acquired, which are crucial, especially in the event of an accident at work. To form an employment contract for a child, written consent from one of the parents or another legal guardian, a medical certificate from a health care institution stating that the child is fit for the specific work, and written consent from the school during the academic year are required.

It is emphasized that children can only perform light duties that are within their physical capabilities and do not negatively impact their safety, health, physical, psychological, moral, or social development. Minors are also prohibited from working in any process involving alcohol (receiving orders, serving).

For young individuals, it's important to know their allowable working hours. During non-school periods, children can work up to 6 hours per day and 30 hours per week. During the school year, they can work up to 12 hours per week: up to 2 hours on school days and up to 6 hours on non-school days, if working during the term or semester, but not during school hours. Adolescents can work no more than 8 hours per day including daily class hours and no more than 40 hours per week including class hours.

Child labor is prohibited during these hours: from 8 PM to 6 AM, and in the morning from 6 AM to 7 AM before classes. There must be at least 2 rest days per week, consecutively if possible, with one being Sunday. Children's daily uninterrupted rest period over 24 hours must be no less than 14 hours. Adolescent work from 10 PM to 6 AM is prohibited. Adolescents must have at least 2 rest days per week, consecutively if possible, one of which should be Sunday. Their daily uninterrupted rest period over 24 hours must be no less than 12 hours.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [High dropout rates]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor quality programmes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Poor learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low readiness of primary graduates]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education? [Other]

To create the best conditions for all students to learn effectively and for teachers to work under normal workloads and receive adequate salaries, the government aims to optimize the school network. This means reducing quality disparities between schools, improving the accessibility of quality education, and ensuring that students have choices in subjects and extracurricular activities.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is free of charge]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).]

Yes

2.3 Higher education For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3[1], and target 4.4[2]. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training. - Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. [2] Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”. [Other]

Article 41 of the Constitution establishes the following provisions - Education in state and municipal general education, vocational, and higher education institutions is free. Higher education is accessible to everyone according to each person's achievements. Well-performing citizens are guaranteed free education in state higher education institutions. Inviting study tools - The annual study fair CAREER & STUDIES in Lithuania (an annual exhibition that raises questions not only about which professions to choose, but also about how our forms of self-realization will look in the future as we face new challenges). Universities organize open days annually, during which it is possible to familiarize oneself with the universities, their study programs, and the opportunities available within the universities.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Higher education is accessible to everyone according to individual abilities. Well performing students shall be guaranteed education at state higher education institutions free of charge. The Law on Education of the Republic of Lithuania establishes the principles upon which the educational system is based, one of them is equal opportunities – the educational system is socially fair, it ensures the implementation of person's rights, it guarantees the access to education for all, the attainment of a general education level and a primary qualification, and creates conditions to develop the acquired qualification or gain a new one. This law also establishes the right and duty of all residents to study, indicating that each citizen and alien, who has the right of permanent or temporary residence in the Republic of Lithuania, has the right to study, attain an education level and a qualification.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor quality programmes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Poor learning outcomes]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Low number of professionally trained professors]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
The number of study places in specific study programs is rarely limited and only by the decision of Higher education institutions themselves. But, it is important to highlight that in Lithuania the voucher system provides a certain number of state funded study places every year and students enrol into state funded or non-state funded study places according to their academic achievements. In 2023 there were 12 339 new bachelor degree students that enrolled into state-funded places and 8 248 students that enrolled into study places that were not state funded. National research shows that it is more difficult for students from poor households (and/or more rural areas) to compete for state funded places. In 2020 a paper delivered by the Government strategic analysis centre showed that the chance to enrol into higher education studies is 51 % lower for students from the poorest households, in comparison with the students from the highest socio-economic group. We are also monitoring the enrolment of students with disabilities which has been slightly decreasing recently - from 1006 first year bachelor degree students with disabilities in 2015 to 571 in 2022. This change is mostly caused by the overall demographic situation and lower number of first-year students, but this number has decreased a little more than the enrolment of all students.
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education]
No
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of literacy programmes]
No
2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)]
Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge learning opportunities]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.]

Yes

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.” - Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked): [Other]

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Projects linked with provision of basic skills were launched, they were prioritised to need on specific regions.
 Projects linked with provision and fostering of second chance education was launched – with the aim to target specific group with no general education.
 The network of regional adults' learning coordinators was established, based on Law on non-formal adult education. The aim of this network is to foster adults participation in Life Long Learning activities.
 A one-stop shop system of Individual Learning Accounts will enable accessible competence development for 18-65 year old adults.
 Relevant legislation:
 · <https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lt/TAD/TAIS.60192/asr>
 · <https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lt/TAD/0e2168e2565a11ee8e3cc6ee348ebf6d?positionInSearchResults=12&searchModelUUID=73fe8edf-c95b-4207-918c-5035800046ae>
 · <https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lt/TAD/35c620a08ef611eea791d94269904d9b?positionInSearchResults=0&searchModelUUID=b9a572a4-9d49-4cdb-9508-f610740af836>
 · <https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lt/TAD/7cfd868674b011eeadbcc0bf53e6c339?positionInSearchResults=0&searchModelUUID=8a40002e-a0d5-4f51-8bf0-4fb74ac57845>

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited access]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Issues of equity and inclusion]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor quality programmes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Limited funding]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Poor learning outcomes]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Low number of professionally trained educators]

No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education? [Other]

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Priority groups receive up to 500 Eur in funding if they choose training through the Individual Learning Accounts system www.kursuok.lt. Some learning programmes offered in the ILA system are more expensive than the allocated funding.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [State monitoring and inspections]

Yes

3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Health and sanitation]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Infrastructure]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Curriculum]
Yes
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Student-teacher ratio]
No
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [School fees (if relevant)]
No
3.1 General measures - Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding: [Other]
The Education Law states that schools can implement general education programs if they meet the general criteria. One of the criteria is that the number of students in the classes of state or municipal schools must meet the minimum number of students allowed, which is set by the Government. The rules for creating a school network approved by the Government also specify an exception, i.e., forming one third and fourth grade of a gymnasium with no fewer than 12 students in a gymnasium structural division (section). https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lt/TAD/acd82c9188fa11e8aa33fe8f0fea665f/asr
- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Violence in schools]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Cost of education]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Conflicts or crises]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Inadequate parental support to education]
No
- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Long distances to schools]
No

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education? [Other]

As in other countries around the world, the quality of education faced challenges due to the Covid-19 pandemic. However, the latest OECD PISA study revealed that the achievements of Lithuanian students did not significantly suffer compared to other countries participating in the PISA study. The 2022 PISA study revealed that the mathematical literacy achievements of Lithuanian fifteen-year-olds are higher than the results of their peers in 56 countries – our country's students scored 475 points, while the OECD average is 472 points. With such achievements, Lithuanian students are ranked 24-25th out of 81 countries. As for reading skills, Lithuanian fifteen-year-olds outperformed peers from 49 countries, but fell behind 31 countries. Lithuania is in 32nd place on the reading skills scale with 472 points. The science literacy results of Lithuania (484 points) are higher than those of 52 countries, but lower than those of 28 countries. The OECD average is 485 points. Lithuania is in the 29-30th position, tied with Portugal.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teacher training is provided without discrimination.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Establishment of performance monitoring systems.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.]

Yes

3.2 Education personnel For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”. - Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked): [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Pursuant to the program of the Government of the Republic of Lithuania, in order to strengthen teacher training, 3 Teacher Training Centres were established in 2018, study programs are renewed, study infrastructure is being developed and modernized. By increasing the attractiveness of pedagogical studies, from 2020 all students of pedagogical programs are provided an increased scholarships.

A teacher of pre-school, pre-primary and general education program teacher needs at least a bachelor's degree and a teacher's qualification. The teacher must also have completed a study program in that subject or pedagogical specialization.

Improving the working conditions of teachers, salaries are increased by 10% every year. From 1 September 2020 the salaries of pre-school and pre-primary teachers are equal to the salaries of general education teachers.

In the parties' agreement on education, there is a provision regarding teachers' salaries - by the end of 2024, the average salary of teachers will amount to 130 percent of the country's average salary, with plans for sustainable salary growth after 2024 (<https://smsm.lrv.lt/media/viesa/saugykla/2024/1/OdR2qpvyHyo.pdf>)

Educational leadership measures are being implemented. Following the introduction of the terms of office of heads of educational institutions, in order to attract competent managers, an action plan was prepared, which provides a system of support for the beginning manager: mentoring, study programs models in higher education institutions, access to the legal services, etc.

The external evaluation of school activities is carried out by the National Education Agency - <https://www.nsa.smm.lt/istaigu-vertinimas/bendrojo-ugdymo-mokyklu-isorinis-vertinimas/>

2023-12-22 legal act - <https://www.e-tar.lt/portal/lt/legalAct/02ee0dd0a0be11eea5a28c81c82193a8>

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Shortages of teaching staff]

Yes

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Lack of training centres]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]

No

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel? [High student – teacher ratio]

No

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Curriculum includes human rights education.]

Yes

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.]

Yes

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.[1] Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1. - Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked): [1] Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”. [Other]

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Civic education in the curriculum aims to achieve several goals:
 Understanding different environments: Students learn about their immediate social, cultural, economic, and natural environments and use various sources to express and substantiate their opinions about people's lives in the past, present, and future.
 Developing observational and research skills: Civic education helps develop the ability to observe and investigate the immediate environment, understand oneself and others within peer groups and the community, communicate and collaborate effectively, be tolerant, and constructively solve emerging problems.
 Exploring community and democratic principles: Through studying their immediate surroundings, students observe the expression of community spirit and democratic principles, understand the rights and duties of citizens, and apply these in making decisions and acting within the community.
 The traditional event “Constitution Exam” takes place in Lithuania every year. Schools and teachers are actively involved in organizing this competition. Students - is one of the largest group of participants. Participants test their knowledge of the Constitution. Much of the competition's tasks are about the human rights.

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:]

Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:][Comment]

The requirements for establishing both public and private schools are established in Article 43 of the Education Law. A school can implement general education programs if it meets all the following general criteria: 1. ☒ Its material resources comply with the educational provision standards approved by the Minister of Education, Science and Sport; 2. ☒ Its learning environment and student workload comply with hygiene norms and legal requirements for student safety and health, ensuring the implementation of educational programs, with the physical and informational environment adapted for students with special educational needs; 3. The management of student education records and other information follows the procedure set by the Minister of Education, Science and Sport, with registers based on electronic diaries; 4. ☒ The education and qualifications of its principal, teachers, and educational support specialists meet the requirements established in this law and by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sport; the education of the principal's deputies and the heads of departments organizing education meet the requirements specified in the Law on Salary and Commission Member Remuneration for Employees of State and Municipal Institutions of the Republic of Lithuania; 5. ☒ The school's education programs, except for those of foreign states and international organizations, comply with the general education plans approved by the Minister of Education, Science and Sport; 6. ☒ It ensures the provision of learning and educational support in accordance with the procedures established by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sport; 7. ☒ The number of students in public or municipal school classes complies with the minimum and/or maximum student numbers determined by the Government, aiming for educational quality, and the economical, efficient, and effective use of state and municipal budget funds, taking into account the level of the general education program, satisfaction of students' educational needs, students' special educational needs, language of instruction, geographical location of the school or the specifics of the region, and the principles of class combination set by the Government; 8. ☒ It ensures equitable and modern quality education opportunities that facilitate student achievement progress – in a state or municipal school, the number of students complies with the minimum allowed by the Government, considering the type and purpose of the school, language of instruction, geographical location of the school or the specifics of the region, and conditions for offering foreign languages, elective subjects, and informal children's education programs to meet the educational needs of students economically, efficiently, and effectively using state and municipal budget funds.

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:]

Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:][Comment]

Article 67 of the Education Law, "Funding of Educational Programs and Schools," stipulates that the funding for formal education programs in state, municipal, and private schools, excluding higher education institutions, and for informal children's education programs, shall be financed from the respective annual budgets of the Republic of Lithuania according to the principles of allocation of educational funds per class (group) and/or per student.

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:]

Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:][Comment]

Parents choose whether their child, until they turn 16, attends lessons in religion or ethics.

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:]

Yes

3.4 Non-state actors in education For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked): [1] Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. [Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:][Comment]

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Registration]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [State monitoring and inspections]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Qualifications of teachers]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Health and sanitation]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Infrastructure]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Curriculum]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Student-teacher ratio]

Yes

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School fees]

No

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [School closures]

No

Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered: [Other]

- Please elaborate:

<https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lt/TAD/TAIS.1480/asr>

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low quality educational infrastructure and materials]

No

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Low number of professionally trained teachers]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [High student – teacher ratio]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Issues in terms of equity and inclusion]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity]
No
- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.]
Yes
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)]
Yes
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.]
Yes
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content , including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.]
Yes
3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.]
Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.]

Yes

3.5 Digital education Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion[1]. - Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked): [1] Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment. [A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.]

Yes

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

There is an order by the Minister of Education, Science, and Sports ON PRINTED AND VARIOUS LEVELS OF INTERACTIVITY VIRTUAL TEXTBOOKS AND EDUCATIONAL TOOLS FOR GENERAL EDUCATION SUBJECTS (/e-seimas.lrs.lt/portal/legalAct/lit/TAD/5dba94f2cc4611ee9269b566387cfeeb?positionInSearchResults=0&searchModelUUID=f0e14f06-39ba-46e9-bbb2-2f4a23921a5f), which defines the requirements for digital technologies.

In the Republic of Lithuania, a textbook for general education subjects (hereinafter – textbook) or an educational tool must meet the following general requirements:

3.1. Textual, visual, digital, and interactive materials must be adapted to achieve the objectives and tasks specified in the subject's general program, develop the competences of students as defined in the subject's general program, correspond to the teaching/learning content defined in the subject's general program, and meet the characteristics of achievement levels specified therein; etc.

<https://edtech.nsa.smm.lt/skaitmenines-kompetencijos/>

The EdTech project contributes to digital transformation - creating opportunities for acquiring and expanding digital competencies, allowing educators to earn a master's degree in computer science or to enhance practical skills in the IT field. It is planned that about 2,200 teachers will be trained.

Future ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies) are included in the updated education curricula. One of six key competences is Digital competence, which apima is the ability to use digital technologies to perform tasks, learn, solve problems, work, communicate, and collaborate, manage information, and create and share digital content efficiently, appropriately, safely, critically, independently, and ethically.

Schools are allocated funds for the development of digital education (in 2024, 20 Euros per student per year), from which they can purchase access to paid digital content (e.g., EDUKA class, EMA electronic learning environment, "Eduten Playground", "Vyturys" digital book library, etc.).

Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework. - Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways]

No

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions]

No

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks]

No

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to internet and/or electricity]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated]
No
- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

4. Strengthening governance systems

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring results are made public]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.]
Yes
- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.]
Yes

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked): [There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.]
Yes
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
https://smsm.lrv.lt/lt/veiklos-sritys-1/smm-svietimas/valstybine-svietimo-prieziura/svietimo-bukles-savivaldybese-apzvalgos/ - Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular. e.g.: https://tukstantmeciomokyklos.lt/ - Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans; There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching. https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/sites/53f21f30-en/index.html?itemId=/content/component/53f21f30-en - confirmation of the resilience of LT education system during crisis.
Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:
https://smsm.lrv.lt/lt/veiklos-sritys-1/smm-svietimas/valstybine-svietimo-prieziura/svietimo-bukles-savivaldybese-apzvalgos/ https://op.europa.eu/en/publication-detail/-/publication/cb10026f-8ce4-11ee-8aa6-01aa75ed71a1/language-en
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Budgetary constraints]
Yes
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data]
No
- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance? [Other]
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.
We cannot say that the dialogue with teachers' unions is poor. It is very intensive and it happens regularly. However, compromise solutions are not always easy to reach.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages]
No
- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources]
No

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments]

No

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked) [Other]